Key Messages

By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts. **Privacy Statement**

- In Honduras and El Salvador, day laborers and small subsistence producers of coffee and basic grains will be classified as Stressed (IPC Phase 2) between August and December, due to lack of employment opportunities in the coffee sector, limited food reserves, and high prices of basic grains resulting from losses to maize and bean crops planted at the start of the 2014 Primera season.
- In Nicaragua, the availability of basic grain reserves and access to alternative sources of income allow subsistence farmer and migrant laborer households located in the dry corridor to be in Minimal acute food insecurity (IPC Phase 1) through September. However, due to the losses in basic grains during the Primera season and increasing prices of red beans, households in vulnerable communities will be Stressed (IPC Phase 2) from October through December.
- The ENSO forecast published by the International Research Institute (IRI) as of mid-August indicates a 56 percent probability of El Niño conditions for the September-November period, while forecasts published by the Central American Climate Outlook Forum for the same period predict below-average rainfall for the Pacific coast region, which will cause losses to Postrera crops.

ZONE	CURRENT ANOMALIES	PROJECTED ANOMALIES
REGIONAL	Significant losses to *Primera* crops in both subsistence and commercial production areas. High prices of grains, primarily red beans, which surpass the five-year average price.	Limited access to basic grains (maize and beans) for the region's most vulnerable households due to crop losses, limited income, and high grain prices. Prolonged periods of rainfall deficits during the vegetative development of *Postrera* crops could affect flowering, while excess rainfall during the harvest could lead to germination and fungal damage to crops.
El SALVADOR	Losses of basic grains during the Primera season in the	Damage to *Postrera* grain production, high prices of basic grains, and lack of

situation in the Pacific, central, and northern regions.

The livestock sector in Nicaragua remains critical, given the lack of financial support to enable small farmers to purchase food, and the absence of a government strategy to enable them to mitigate the effects of the drought.

In Nicaragua, the decrease in rice production is estimated at 25 percent. However, both producers and commercial enterprises are calling for actions that will maintain the supply and stabilize prices, as existing stock will satisfy demand for a period of only three months. They are also requesting a renegotiation of the volumes of rice that may be imported within the tariff contingency mechanism, based on the country's needs.

By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts. Privacy Statement

In addition to maize and beans, the region's Primera cycle rice crops have been significantly affected. However, any imbalance in supply at the national level can be offset by imports, toward which end both farmers and commercial enterprises can request that revisions be made to the volumes of rice that can be imported, as established in tariff contingency plans.

Among remotely monitored countries, only Honduras has published official data on production losses and number of households affected by the lack of rainfall for Primera season crops, with preliminary data indicating that there could be 17 percent losses of maize crops. For El Salvador, estimates for maize losses are 14 percent, while in Nicaragua, where periods of drought affected larger areas of the country, it is estimated that there are 75 percent crop losses (including losses stemming from the inability to plant). Nevertheless, the government has indicated in the media that losses are closer to 14 percent.

Coffee Rust Situation

According to the coffee rust early warning system, which surveys 241 farms in El Salvador, as of the end of July the greatest number of farms affected by coffee rust in the country were located along the Apaneca-Ilamatepeca mountain range, where 9.59 percent of farms were infested, followed by the area along the Cacahuatique mountain range, with a rate of 9.18 percent. Together, these two mountainous areas account for more than 50 percent of national production and, accordingly, provide the greatest source of labor opportunities involving coffee harvesting.

In the survey conducted in Honduras, coffee growers indicated that irregular